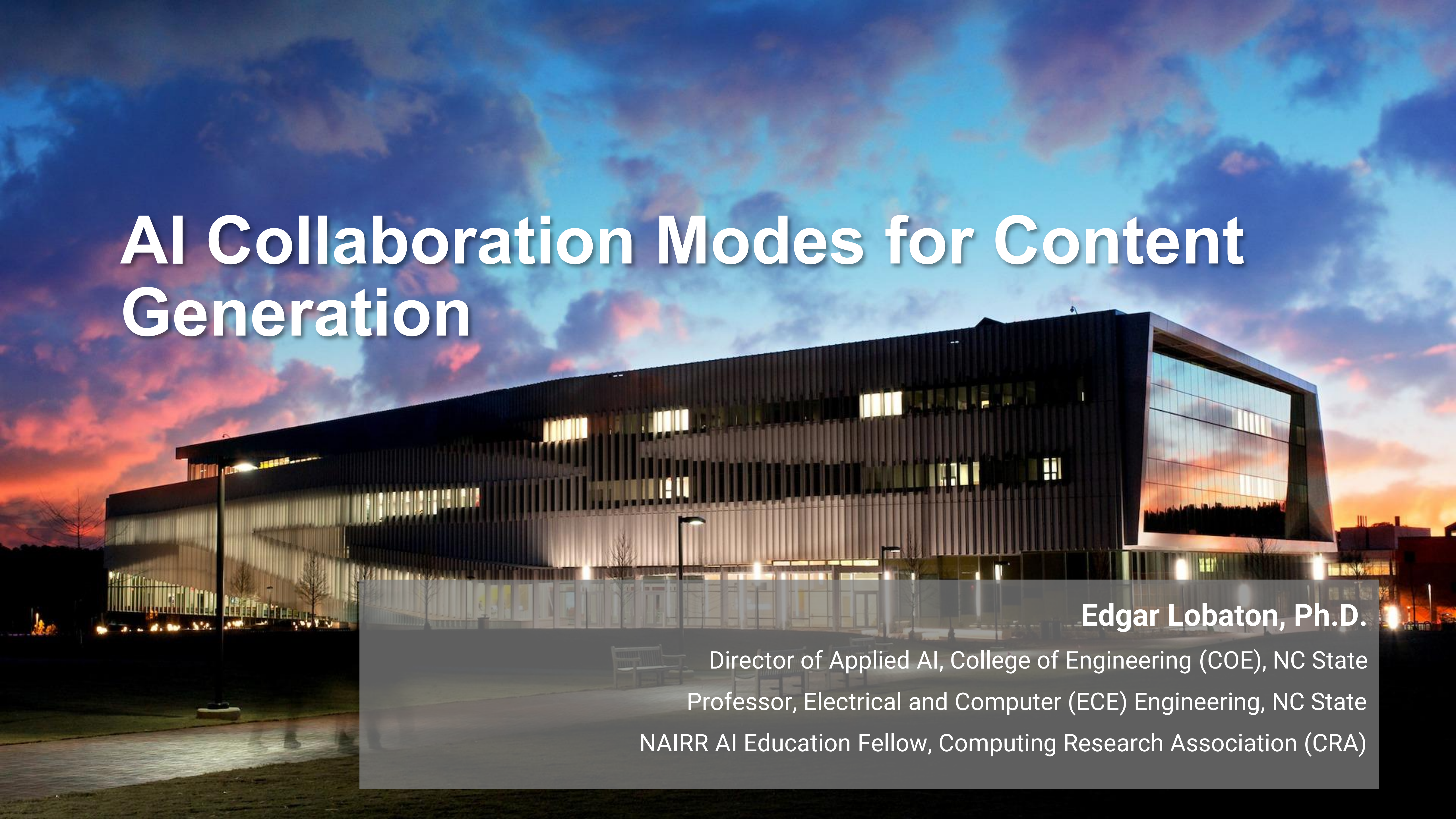

AI Collaboration Modes for Content Generation

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Three Modes of Working with an AI Code Assistant

Cyborgs, Centaurs, and Self-Automators — from a Harvard Business School study of AI-assisted knowledge work

Centaur

A clean division of labor. You decide what needs to happen, then delegate one bounded piece to the AI — and take control back to verify it.

Cyborg

Continuous interleaving, not a clean split. You and the AI go back and forth repeatedly within the same task — no clear line between "your part" and "its part."

Self-Automator

The whole task goes to the AI. One high-level prompt, minimal ongoing engagement, review only at the end.

Let's think of examples of use on non-coding tasks

https://www.hbs.edu/ris/Publication%20Files/26-036_e7d0e59a-904c-49f1-b610-56eb2bdfe6f9.pdf

Same ML Task, Three Different Workflows

What each mode looks like when building a model with an AI code assistant

	Centaur	Cyborg	Self-Automator
Your role	*Decide architecture & strategy yourself*	*Co-write live — start, edit, hand off, repeat*	*Write one high-level prompt*
AI's role	*Handles one bounded, delegated task*	*Continuously drafts, edits, explains errors with you*	*Runs the pipeline end-to-end, largely unattended*
Example prompt	*"Write the training loop for this architecture"*	*Live back-and-forth fixing a failing test together*	*"Build a model that predicts X from this dataset"*

None of these is "the right way" — the point is recognizing which mode you're in and choosing it on purpose.

Designing an ML Workflow

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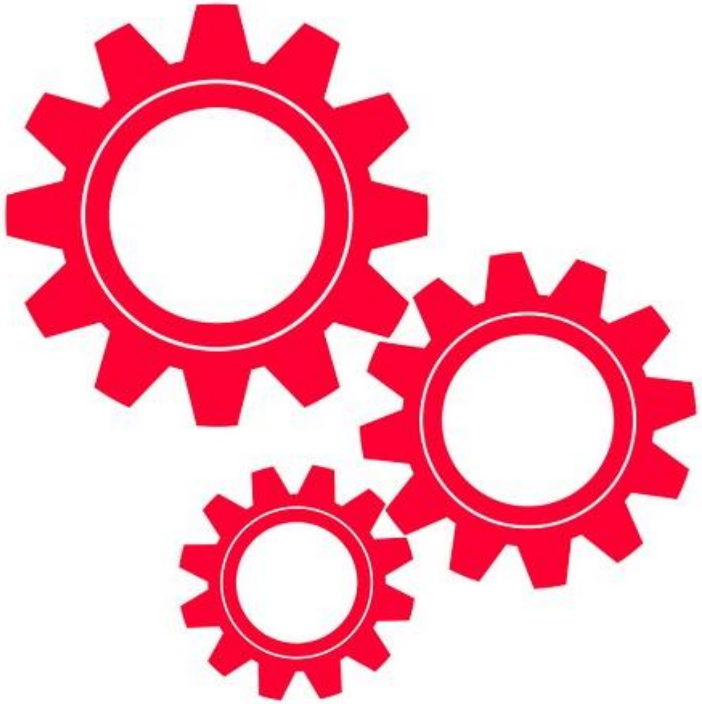
The Problem: Synthetic Gait Classification

- We are aiming to develop a personalize model that determine when a person is walking fast or slow. We have conducted two recording sessions, in which the individual switches between fast and slow walking periodically. Let’s build a model that predicts which gait it is observed in the data.

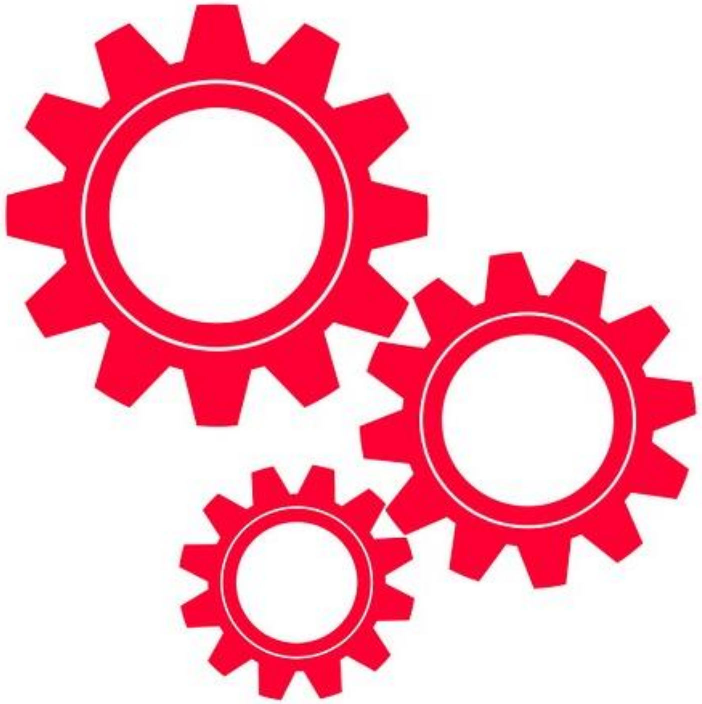
The Problem: Synthetic Gait Classification

- Let’s do this as a Self-Automator



The Problem: Synthetic Gait Classification

- Let's do this as a Centaur



The Problem: Synthetic Gait Classification

- Let's refine as a Cyborg